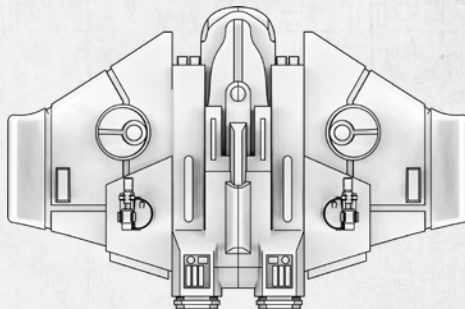


KIR'LA (WARDEN) CLASS GUNSHIP

30 PTS



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Escort/1	25 cm	90°	1	5+	1
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED	FIREPOWER/STR		FIRE ARC
Prow Railgun battery		30 cm	2		Front
Prow ion cannon		30 cm	1		Left/front/right
SPECIAL - Any Tau fleet may bring Wardens to battle on gravitic hooks instead of Orcas. - Any ship equipped with Wardens can only be equipped with Wardens and may not have other hook-transported escorts. - These then form an independent squadron in all respects (including separate leadership), as they are Kor'or'vesh vessels and not necessarily related to the parent vessel transporting them. They may squadron with Castellon escorts in the fleet if present (max. six per squadron) but not with any other escort types.					

The Kir'la "Warden" is a radical departure in gunship design for the Kor'vattra in that while it still requires towing via gravitic sheath by larger vessels, it is designed for and crewed primarily as a combat vessel as opposed to being a re-configured cargo lighter as is the Kess'l. Because of this, it can seamlessly integrate itself into Kor'or'vesh flotillas, though it will still operate independently as an escort squadron when assigned to escort Gal'Leath or Il'fannor vessels of the Kor'vattra. Because of the high experience levels of its crews and its superior maneuvering qualities when compared to the K'essl, it has proven to be a formidable adversary to attacking raiders. However, its numbers will not be sufficient to replace the Kess'l in active service for quite some time because of its complexity, and only rarely is it used in this manner.

Despite technological advances in etherdrive technology, the Kir'la's small size makes it extremely difficult to put an efficient interstellar drive system into its hull. Thus it must always be towed into combat and launched after its mother ship enters a system. The Or'es El'leath is specially designed to quickly deploy these vessels immediately upon entering combat, and it operates with the Kir'la exclusively as its towed gunship escort. While Wardens have been on occasion used in other roles, it was designed primarily to protect their vitally important carrier battleships and will rarely be seen too far from their side.

FLEET LISTS Merchant Fleet List (pg. 434), Commerce Protection Fleet List (pg. 436)